Virtue Ethics: Group Reflection

Group members:

Section (circle one)	12:30pm	2:00pm

Work through these questions together as a group. Turn in one sheet per group at the end of class.

(1) As a group, discuss your role models (i.e. "exemplars"). Write down three of them below, along with the **virtues** your group thinks they emulate in their character traits. For this exercise, they must be real people.

(2) Now do the same for "anti-role models" (i.e. negative exemplars). Write down two or three, along with the **vices** your group sees in their character traits. Again, they must be real people.

(Questions 3 and 4 are on the back)

(3) According to virtue ethics, a person's happiness and flourishing (i.e. eudaemonia) is connected to morals and values: to flourish, a person must live in accordance with virtues. Write down character-focused virtues you think a typical UIC student might wish to develop this semester, then discuss as a group and write down a concrete way that student might practice developing it.

***Example**: for the virtue of friendliness, a concrete practice might be asking follow-up questions whenever you meet someone new.*

Virtue	*Concrete practice(s)*

(4) According to virtue ethics, a virtue and a vice often exist on the same scale: the virtue is the "golden mean" between having too little of something and too much of it. As a group, choose some example virtues, then work out what they would look like in **deficiency** and in **excess**. For example, excess honesty might be "boastful."

***Some virtues to choose from**: courage, ambition, generosity, patience, honesty, whimsy / wittiness, friendliness — and many more!*

Deficiency (vice)	*Virtue (golden mean)*	*Excess (vice)*